

Lessons from Christ's Final Week

HOLY WEEK PRAYER GUIDE

APRIL 13-20, 2025

Welcome to our Holy Week prayer experience. Come and reflect on Christ's final week—His journey to the cross and His victorious resurrection. Jesus is unlike any other—no mere teacher, prophet, or leader, but God in the flesh, full of love, power, and humility. In Him, heaven touched earth, and through His sacrifice, we are invited into a life beyond what we could ever imagine.

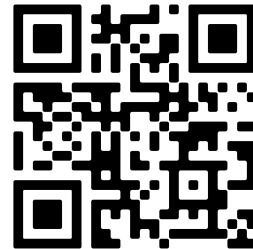
This sacred season is a time to pause, draw near to Him, and deepen our connection through scripture, reflection, and prayer. We encourage you to carry this guide with you, engage with it personally or with your family, and join us in daily prayer meetings. May this be a time of encountering the One who changes everything.

Daily Virtual Prayer Meetings

Mornings (Mon-Fri): 7:30-8:15 am

Afternoons (Fri): 12:15-1:00 pm

Evenings (Mon, Tue, Thu): 8:15-9:00 pm



Pastors Hazen and Hannah Stevens

Where we meet - Roam Buckhead, 3365 Piedmont Rd NE #1400, Atlanta, GA 30305

Website - <https://www.gatecitybuckhead.com/>

Palm Sunday – Jesus's Triumphant Entry into Jerusalem

- **Scripture Focus**

- **John 12:12-15-** *"The next day the great crowd that had come for the festival heard that Jesus was on his way to Jerusalem. 13 They took palm branches and went out to meet him, shouting, 'Hosanna!' 'Blessed is He who comes in the name of the Lord!' 'Blessed is the king of Israel!' 14 Jesus found a young donkey and sat on it, as it is written: 15 'Do not be afraid, Daughter Zion; see, your king is coming, seated on a donkey's colt.'"*

- **Devotional**

- Reflect on the contrast between the crowds' initial praise and later rejection of Christ. How quickly the human heart can be changed. Imagine Jesus, having left all His glory in heaven, to humbly sit upon a donkey entering the very city of Jerusalem where He would one day rule and reign. He would have known that the people currently welcoming Him would later be the ones to shout, "Crucify Him!" And still...His steadfast love and resolve to do the Father's will compelled Him to lay His life down for all who in one moment praise Him, and in another, betray.

- **Prayer**

- *Heavenly Father, thank You for sending your Son, Jesus, our King. Jesus, thank you for leaving Your glorious throne to humbly sacrifice Your life. Forgive me for ways that my heart has been fickle before You. Help me to remain steadfast and faithful to You, even when it is difficult. Give me an undivided heart to fear Your name! Hosanna in the highest! Amen.*

- **Personal Reflection**

- What are some ways that I praise Jesus with my mouth but resist Him with my actions?
- How might the Lord be inviting me to be more wholehearted and authentic in my worship to Him?

- **Gather Around the Table**

- Discuss with loved ones, "How can we cultivate a home or community that glorifies the Father with our actions and words?"

- **A Step Deeper...**

- Spend a few moments reading Psalm 118:1-2, 19-29. Offer the Lord your heartfelt prayers acknowledging Jesus as King.
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Holy Monday – Christ's Zeal for the Father's Will

Daily Virtual Prayer Times - 7:30-8:15a, 8:15-9p

- **Scripture Focus**

- **Mark 11:17-** *"And He taught them and said to them, 'Is it not written, 'My house shall be called a house of prayer for all the nations'? But you have made it a den of robbers."*

- **Devotional**

- Upon His final days in Jerusalem, imagine Christ's arrival to the temple court. What had been built as a sacred space for worship and prayer, was now filled with noises of bleating sheep to be sold and the hurried pace of shouting merchants. Tables of money blocked the way of entry to meet with God in the temple. Jesus, full of zeal for His Father's house, could not stand by silent. He had come to clear every obstacle that would hinder His true followers from entering God's presence, even at the cost of His own life.

- **Prayer**

- *Sovereign Lord, thank You for Your zeal for holiness, righteousness, and communion between God and man. Please ignite in me a fire that burns for more of Your presence. Help me to honor Your name and to seek Your kingdom above all else. Purify my heart that I may worship You in Spirit and in truth. Amen.*

- **Personal Reflection**

- Jesus was filled with zeal for the Father's will. How is the Lord inviting me into deeper zeal for His Kingdom and purposes?
- How can I protect the sacred things of God in my life?

- **Gather Around the Table**

- Discuss with loved ones, what does it mean to make our home a true house of prayer? Who can we invite in to join us?

- **A Step Deeper...**

- Read Isaiah 56:4-8 to contextualize Christ's words. Ponder what He may be speaking to you through this passage.
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Holy Tuesday— Christ's Surrender to the Father's Will

Daily Virtual Prayer Times - 7:30-8:15a, 8:15-9p

- **Scripture Focus**

- **John 12:22-25, 27-28-** *"Philip went to tell Andrew; Andrew and Philip in turn told Jesus. 23 Jesus replied, 'The hour has come for the Son of Man to be glorified. 24 Very truly I tell you, unless a kernel of wheat falls to the ground and dies, it remains only a single seed. But if it dies, it produces many seeds. 25 Anyone who loves their life will lose it, while anyone who hates their life in this world will keep it for eternal life... 'Now my soul is troubled, and what shall I say? 'Father, save me from this hour'? No, it was for this very reason I came to this hour. 28 Father, glorify Your name!'"*

- **Devotional**

- Jesus beautifully illustrates the imagery of a kernel of wheat to demonstrate the principle of death that leads to multiplied life. To grow, a seed must fall, its outer shell breaking, and it seems as though it has died. It is not unto destruction, but brings forth transformation. That single seed now yields a harvest far greater than itself. Just as the seed's death births forth new life, so too, Jesus's sacrifice in surrender to the Father's will, excruciating as it was, brought forth a harvest. He paved the way for countless souls to enter the Kingdom of God. How good is our Father, who uses what appears as loss to create immeasurable gain, not only in eternity, but today in our lives

- **Prayer**

- *Abba Father, please grant me the strength to surrender my will to Yours, no matter the cost, just as Jesus did. Help me to trust in Your perfect plan and to glorify Your name. May my life be a seed that is sown into the ground to produce much fruit for Your kingdom. Amen.*

- **Personal Reflection**

- Where do I sense an invitation to surrender—places of pain, loss, or struggle where God is calling me to trust Him?
- Prayerfully reflect on how the Lord is bringing new life to those places. Ask Him to show you more. Write your reflections.

- **Gather Around the Table**

- Discuss with loved ones, how is the Lord inviting us together into deeper surrender to God's will? Where is He stretching our faith to trust Him?

- **A Step Deeper...**

- Jesus taught in parables in His final week to illustrate His impending death, through imagery of the destruction and rebuilding of the temple in 3 days. For further reading, meditate on John 2:18-22.

Spy Wednesday: The Betrayal of Jesus

Daily Virtual Prayer Times - 7:30-8:15a

- **Scripture Focus**

- **Matthew 26:14-16-** *"Then one of the twelve, whose name was Judas Iscariot, went to the chief priests and said, 'What will you give me if I deliver Him over to you?' And they paid him thirty pieces of silver. And from that moment he sought an opportunity to betray Him."*

- **Devotional**

- Have you ever felt the sharp pain of betrayal from someone you let into your trusted inner circle? Consider Jesus, sharing His last supper with His disciples, the very ones He loved and trusted. Then, the shocking truth: Judas, one of them, traded Christ's life for thirty pieces of silver, the price of a slave's life in Old Testament law (Exodus 21:32). Think of the immeasurable pain in Jesus's heart, yet His love compelled Him forward to the cross. While we've each betrayed Him in our own ways, He willingly took our punishment, carried all of our sin and took the punishment that we deserved. How humble, how mighty, how truly amazing is our Lord?

- **Prayer**

- *Lord Jesus, I am grieved over the ways I have turned my back on You. Please forgive me for how I have betrayed Your love and resisted Your Lordship. Thank You for Your sacrifice, which paid the price for my redemption. Empower me to live a life worthy of Your name. Amen.*

- **Personal Reflection**

- Pause and allow your heart to feel the pain of your experience of betrayal. Let the sorrow of your own sin produce genuine repentance.
- Confess it to the Lord and receive His forgiveness washing over you. His blood was shed to make you new.
- Express your gratitude to Him for His great love and mercy!

- **Gather Around the Table...**

- Discuss with loved ones, what are some modern-day 'thirty pieces of silver' that tempt us to betray our values or our faith?
- How can we support each other in remaining faithful to God and to one another?

- **A Step Deeper...**

- Further suggested readings: Exodus 21:32, Zechariah 11:11-13
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Maundy Thursday – The Last Supper

Daily Virtual Prayer Times - 7:30-8:15a, 8:15-9p

- **Scripture Focus**

- **John 13:3-5** *“Jesus knew that the Father had put all things under his power, and that he had come from God and was returning to God; 4 so he got up from the meal, took off his outer clothing, and wrapped a towel around his waist. 5 After that, he poured water into a basin and began to wash his disciples’ feet, drying them with the towel that was wrapped around him.”*

- **Devotional**

- Jesus and His closest disciples gather to share a final meal together the night before His death, the eve of the Passover feast. They would later come to see that this feast was pointing to Him. Christ was the Passover Lamb who would shed His blood for them and all mankind, even when betrayed and abandoned in His greatest hour of need, pleading with the Father for His life in the Garden of Gethsemane. And how does He choose to spend these final moments with them? He takes off His outer garment, kneels down, and washes their feet, showing again His true nature as a humble servant. The greatest, most worthy One among them, among us, knelt down to the lowest place to give of Himself for our benefit. He invites us to go and do likewise in honor of our Lord.

- **Prayer**

- *Lord Jesus, thank You for Your example of selfless humility and service. Help me to love and serve others as You have loved me. I ask for grace to live in daily communion with you. Today I renew my commitment to You. Amen.*

- **Personal Reflection**

- What does this passage reveal to me about Jesus?
- What are ways that Jesus is inviting me into deeper servanthood and humility?

- **Gather Around the Table...**

- Take communion with your loved ones in commemoration of Christ, our Passover Lamb. His body was broken and His blood was shed for the forgiveness of our sins.

- **A Step Deeper..**

- Read the full account of John 13:1-15 and wash one another's feet or take communion, exhibiting the nature of Christ, and serving those you love.
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Good Friday – Jesus's Crucifixion, The Passover Lamb of God

Daily Virtual Prayer Times - 7:30-8:15a, 12:15-1p

- **Scripture Focus**

- **Luke 23:44-46**- *"It was now about noon, and darkness came over the whole land until three in the afternoon, 45 for the sun stopped shining. And the curtain of the temple was torn in two. 46 Jesus called out with a loud voice, "Father, into Your hands I commit My spirit." When He had said this, He breathed His last."*

- **Devotional**

- Let us solemnly behold Christ on the cross. Bloodied, marred beyond recognition, and struggling to breathe. He continues to extend His love, His arms outstretched wide, showing mercy and forgiveness to those whose very hands caused His anguish, asking the Father to forgive them and overlook their sin. He extends an invitation to paradise to a condemned man beside Him. In His final breath, He releases His Spirit to the Father, and all of creation responds—the sun ceases to shine, the earth quakes, tombs open, and those once buried in the grave, rose, and appeared to many in Jerusalem. Christ's death—a cataclysmic event—broke open the way to eternal life. He was the sin offering, the Passover Lamb, to take away the sins of the world.

- **Prayer**

- *Lord Jesus, I stand in awe of You. Thank You for Your sacrifice and unending love, mercy, and forgiveness towards humanity. There is no other God but You, who could take upon the sin of all as the perfect, spotless Lamb. May I live as a living sacrifice unto You, expressing my gratitude through my love and obedience. Amen.*

- **Personal Reflection**

- Reflect on the immense suffering and sacrifice of Jesus on the cross. Consider and receive the depth of his love for you and the power of His forgiveness.
- What does it mean for me that Jesus asked the Father to forgive those who crucified Him?

- **Gather Around the Table...**

- With your loved ones, spend a moment of silence and contemplation of Christ on the Cross. Take time to pray together, expressing gratitude for the sacrifice of Jesus and interceding for those who need to know the Savior.

- **A Step Deeper...**

- Further reading of the full Gospel accounts of Christ's crucifixion in Matthew 27:27-56, Mark 15:16-41, John 19:16-37
- The Significance of Christ as the spotless lamb of God – Exodus 12:5, John 1:29, 1 Corinthians 5:7

Holy Saturday – Waiting in Anticipation, Christ's Burial

- **Scripture Focus**

- **Luke 23:55-56-** *"The women who had come with Jesus from Galilee followed Joseph and saw the tomb and how his body was laid in it.⁵⁶ Then they went home and prepared spices and perfumes. But they rested on the Sabbath in obedience to the commandment."*

- **Devotional**

- Have you ever experienced the tension of waiting and hoping for something to come, trusting in faith? Imagine the disciples—dispersed, confused, and disillusioned. The One they believed to be the coming Messiah was gone. Some returned to their previous vocations, doing what they knew. But others clung to hope, even as their own hands prepared His body for burial. Though He lay lifeless in their arms, could it truly be that He would live again? Often, faith is the only evidence we have, and we must cling to God's word while waiting for it to manifest in what we can see. Take heart today as you wait; His word cannot return void, and we will inherit His promises through faith and patience.

- **Prayer**

- *Father God, in the times of waiting on You, strengthen my faith and fill me with anticipation for Your resurrection power. Help me to find peace in Your presence and to trust in Your promises through all circumstances. Thank You that joy always comes in the morning. Amen.*

- **Personal Reflection**

- What am I waiting on God for in my own life? How can I receive fresh faith to believe today from His Spirit.
- Reflect on the silence and stillness of the tomb. Consider the hope that lies in the waiting and knowing that resurrection is coming.

- **Gather Around the Table...**

- Discuss with your loved ones, how can we find strength in God's promises during times of waiting?
- How can we encourage and support one another during those times?

- **A Step Deeper...**

- For further reading, meditate on the example of faith from the great cloud of witnesses that has gone before us in Hebrews 11.
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Resurrection Sunday - Christ's Glorious Resurrection!

- **Scripture Focus**

- **Matthew 28:5-6**- *"The angel said to the women, "Do not be afraid, for I know that you are looking for Jesus, who was crucified. He is not here; He has risen, just as He said. Come and see the place where He lay."*

- **Devotional**

- *"He is not here; He has risen, just as He said..."* Imagine the women's relief and utter shock at the sight of an angel standing before them in an empty tomb—the very place where they had laid His body two days prior. Jesus Himself met them on the road, granting them the honor of being the first to see Him in His risen body! Death had been overcome, the grave conquered, and the King once again proved His Word to be true. The One who is "the Word of God in the flesh" demonstrated that the same power that breathed everything into existence has the authority not only to create life, but to resurrect it.

- **Prayer**

- *Heavenly Father, through Jesus Christ, your Son, You triumphed over death and the grave! Thank You for offering us the promise of eternal life! I ask for the release of Your resurrection power to flow in and through me. Christ, our Risen King, we exalt You as the One True God, both now and forever more. Amen.*

- **Personal Reflection**

- Reflect on the glorious victory of Jesus over death. Where am I needing God's resurrection power to manifest in my own life or the life of another?
- What tombs am I believing will be emptied?

- **Gather Around the Table...**

- Share a meal and celebrate Christ's resurrection with loved ones. Take some time to discuss how you have seen God bring His power of life to you or those around you.

- **A Step Deeper...**

- Express your gratitude to Christ and spend time worshipping Him on your own or with others! We will live because He lives! Praise the Lord!
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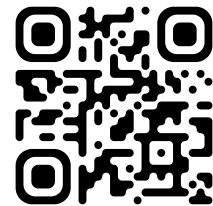
Invitation to Salvation

Thank you for walking with us through Christ's final week. In Him, we behold a love and power unlike any other—God Himself, clothed in flesh, carrying our sin, and laying down His life so that we might receive His. Perhaps this week has stirred something deep within you—a fresh invitation to surrender. To bow your allegiance to Jesus, release anything that takes His rightful place, and fully entrust your life to Him.

If you're ready to take that step—or renew your commitment to live fully surrendered to Christ—we invite you to pray this prayer:

Prayer of Surrender:

Jesus, I recognize that You are unlike any other. You are the Son of God, who took on flesh, bore my sins, and gave Your life so that I could be made new. Today, I surrender my heart to You. I lay down my own ways, my idols, and anything that separates me from You. I bow my allegiance to You as my Savior and King.



Forgive me, cleanse me, and fill me with Your Holy Spirit. Lead me in Your truth, and help me to walk in Your love every day. I choose to trust You, to follow You, and to live for Your glory.

In Your name, Jesus, I pray. Amen.

If you've made a fresh commitment to Jesus, we want to walk with you on this journey. Scan the QR code on this page to share what God is doing in your life. We'd love to support, encourage, and pray for you as you take this next step.

This devotional is a gift from GateCity Buckhead, a community devoted to prayer, discipleship, and mission. Our passion is to see lives transformed by Jesus, shaped through community, and empowered to impact the world.

Following Christ is more than belief—it's a way of life. It means embracing prayer, service, generosity, spiritual growth, and outreach. Rooted in both personal and corporate prayer, we pursue a deep connection with God while building authentic relationships that strengthen our faith.

With a heart for worship and a mission to reach the unreached, we are committed to sharing the gospel and carrying the love of Jesus into every sphere of life. If you're looking for a church community, we'd love for you to join us on a Sunday! Let us know you're coming by scanning this QR code—we'd love to welcome you with a special gift and a great cup of coffee on the house!

